

UNIT III: GROUP BEHAVIOR

INTRODUCTION TO GROUP BEHAVIOUR

Meaning of Group Behaviour

Group behaviour refers to the **study of how individuals behave when they are part of a group** and how groups function within organizations. In organizational settings, employees rarely work in isolation; instead, they interact continuously with coworkers, supervisors, teams, and committees. According to Stephen P. Robbins, a group can be defined as **two or more individuals who interact and are interdependent, coming together to achieve particular objectives**. Group behaviour therefore focuses on understanding the dynamics, interactions, and psychological processes that occur when people work together.

Fred Luthans emphasizes that group behaviour examines not only individual actions within a group but also how the group as a whole behaves, makes decisions, resolves conflicts, and achieves goals. Understanding group behaviour is essential because most organizational activities such as problem solving, decision making, project execution, and innovation are carried out through groups rather than individuals.

Nature of Group Behaviour

Group behaviour is complex and dynamic in nature. It involves interaction among members with different personalities, attitudes, perceptions, and values. When individuals join a group, their behaviour is influenced by group norms, roles, and expectations. Uday Pareek explains that groups develop their own identities, cultures, and patterns of functioning over time. As a result, the behaviour of individuals in groups is often different from their behaviour when they work alone.

Groups create social relationships and emotional bonds among members. They influence motivation, communication, leadership, and performance. Because groups consist of multiple individuals, they often generate **synergy**, where collective performance becomes greater than the sum of individual efforts. At the same time, groups can also produce negative effects such as conflicts, conformity pressures, and groupthink. Therefore, managing group behaviour effectively is a major challenge for organizations.

Importance of Studying Group Behaviour

Understanding group behaviour is important for several reasons.

First, organizations depend heavily on **teams and work groups** to accomplish tasks. Effective group behaviour leads to higher productivity, better decision making, and improved problem solving. When employees cooperate and coordinate effectively, organizational goals can be achieved more efficiently.

Second, groups strongly influence **individual attitudes and behaviour**. Employees derive identity, support, and satisfaction from group membership. Positive group behaviour improves morale, job satisfaction, and commitment, while negative group behaviour leads to stress, conflict, and low performance.

Third, most organizational decisions are made in groups such as committees, task forces, and project teams. Understanding group processes helps managers design better decision-making systems and avoid problems like domination by a few members or poor-quality decisions.

Fourth, group behaviour affects **communication and coordination**. Well-managed groups improve information sharing and cooperation across departments. Schermerhorn points out that groups are the basic building blocks of organizations, and organizational success largely depends on how well groups function.

ORGANIZATION STRUCTURE – FORMATION – GROUPS IN ORGANIZATION

Meaning of Organization Structure

Organization structure refers to the **formal system of task and authority relationships** that controls how people coordinate their actions and use resources to achieve organizational goals. According to Stephen P. Robbins, organizational structure defines how job tasks are formally divided, grouped, and coordinated. It determines who reports to whom, how communication flows, and how decisions are made. Organization structure provides a framework within which groups and individuals function and perform their roles.

Fred Luthans explains that structure is essential because it brings order and clarity to organizational activities. Without a clear structure, there would be confusion, duplication of effort, and lack of coordination. Thus, organizational structure forms the foundation for group behaviour and performance.

Importance of Organization Structure

Organization structure is important because it helps in the **efficient allocation of resources and responsibilities**. It clarifies authority relationships, enabling employees to know their duties, reporting lines, and decision-making powers. A well-designed structure facilitates coordination among different departments and groups, reduces conflicts, and improves communication.

Structure also influences employee behaviour, motivation, and performance. It affects how groups are formed, how leaders emerge, and how work is carried out. Schermerhorn points out that organizational structure shapes the culture and work climate of an organization, thereby influencing overall effectiveness.

Elements of Organization Structure

According to Robbins, organization structure consists of six key elements:

1. **Work Specialization** – Division of tasks into specialized jobs.
2. **Departmentalization** – Grouping jobs into departments.
3. **Chain of Command** – Formal line of authority.
4. **Span of Control** – Number of subordinates reporting to a manager.
5. **Centralization and Decentralization** – Level at which decisions are made.
6. **Formalization** – Degree of rules and procedures.

These elements together determine how groups are created and coordinated in organizations.

TYPES OF ORGANIZATIONAL STRUCTURE

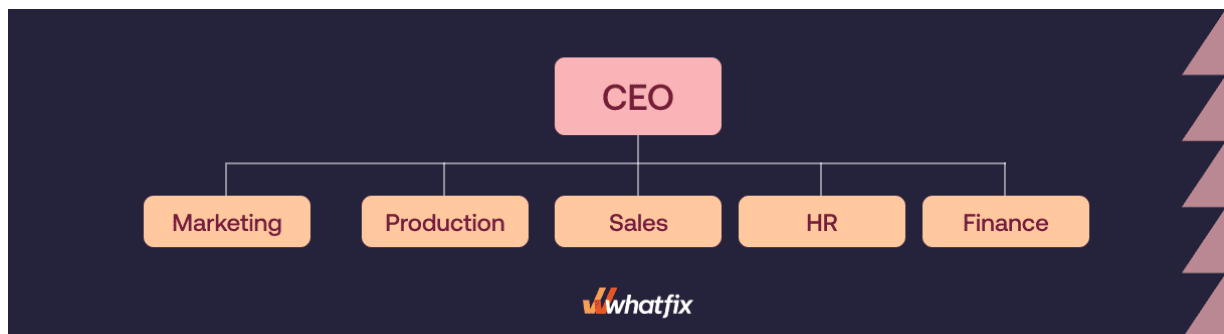
Organizational structure refers to the formal arrangement of jobs, authority, communication channels, and responsibilities within an organization. It determines how tasks are divided, coordinated, and supervised. According to Robbins, organizational structure defines how job tasks are formally divided, grouped, and coordinated. Luthans emphasizes that structure influences employee behavior, communication patterns, power relationships, and overall organizational effectiveness.

The key purpose of any organizational structure is to make decision-making processes straightforward and provide clear definitions for roles and responsibilities. However, there are many ways to achieve that.

1. Functional structure:

A functional structure groups employees into different departments by work specialization. Each department has a designated leader highly experienced in the job functions of each employee supervised by them.

Most often, it implements a top-down (centralized) decision-making process where department managers report to upper management. Ideally, leaders of different teams communicate regularly and coordinate their strategies while lower-level employees have little idea of the processes taking place outside their department.



The main challenge companies with a functional structure face is the lack of coordination between departments. Employees may lose the larger company context when focusing on specific tasks and failing to interact with members of other departments. You'll need to train leaders to foster collaboration across departments to create a functional organizational structure. Best For: Companies that require a high degree of specialization and efficiency within each department, like manufacturing firms.

Pros of a functional organizational structure:

- Scalable.
- Operational efficiency.
- Encourages employees to specialize their skillsets.
- Empower employees to focus on their specific roles and responsibilities.
- Empowers teams and departments with clear, specific goals that they can work towards.

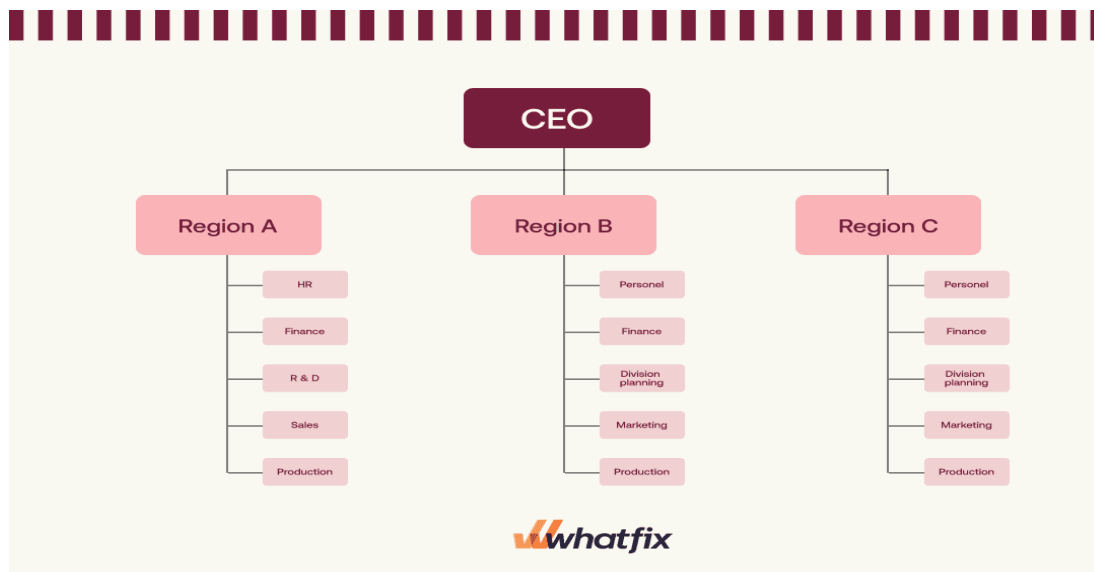
Cons of a functional org structure:

- Leads to poor cross-department communication.
- Builds silos.
- Creates obscure roles, processes, and workflows that are company or industry-specific.

2. Divisional structure:

In a divisional organizational structure, the company is divided into different business units that have complete control of their budget, resources, and strategy – essentially acting as an independent company. Each division can have its own dedicated marketing, sales, product, and IT teams. A divisional structure works well with large enterprises who have multi-product offerings, have acquired or merged with multiple business entities, service many geographical regions, and serve different industries. Examples of companies applying a divisional structure are McDonald's Corporation and Disney. These brands can't help but split the entire organization by location to be able to adjust their strategies for audiences representing different markets. These smaller groups are relatively independent and mainly follow a decentralized

framework. Still, the leaders of each department are likely to operate under centralized corporate management. This means that the company culture is dictated by top management, but operational decisions can be made independently by each division.



Pros of a divisional organizational structure:

- Understand individual markets, sectors, and products better.
- Promotes flexibility.
- Faster responses to changes or needs that are locality or regional-based.
- Autonomous approaches lead to team experimentation and allow organizations to test multiple strategies, driving innovation.

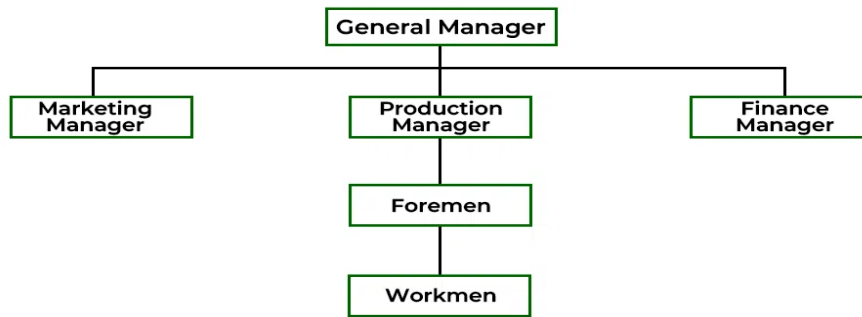
Cons of a divisional structure:

- Can result in duplication efforts like multiple applications that do the same thing.
- Siloed teams and data with poor knowledge transfer.
- Poor documentation.
- Lack of organizational communication.
- Departments compete against one another.
- Lack of hierarchy understanding.

3. Line Organisation

Line organisation, also known as a scalar or military organisation, is the simplest and oldest form of organisational structure. It is characterised by a clear and direct chain of command, where authority flows vertically from top to bottom. Each employee has a single supervisor to whom they report, creating a clear line of responsibility and accountability. Decision-making is typically centralised at the top of the hierarchy, with limited delegation. This structure is suitable for small organisations with a straightforward hierarchy, where decision-making needs to be efficient and communication is direct. However, it can lead to delays in decision-making as all decisions must pass through the hierarchy, and communication can be limited to the immediate supervisor. No staff specialists are available in line organisation and all the persons at the same level are independent of each other.

Line Organisation

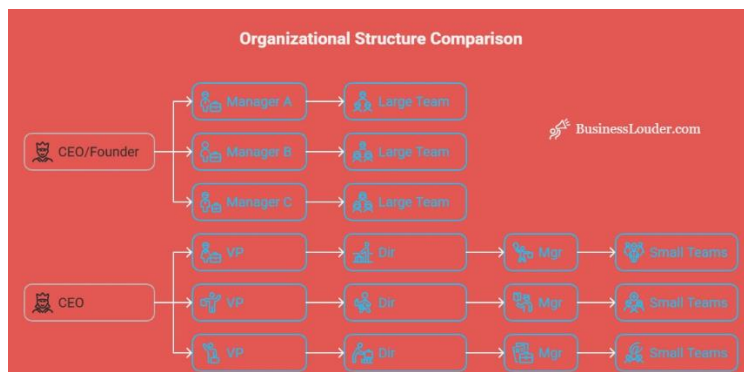


4. Flat (Horizontal) Organizational Structure

The flat structure minimizes or eliminates middle management layers between executives and front-line employees. This creates a wide span of control with emphasis on employee empowerment and direct communication.

Real-World Examples:

Valve Corporation (video game company) operates with no formal management hierarchy where employees choose which projects to work on and uses peer-based evaluation. Buffer (social media management platform) maintains minimal hierarchy with transparent operations, self-organizing teams, and public salaries with open decision-making. GitHub (before Microsoft acquisition) operated with limited management layers, employee autonomy in project selection, and collaborative decision-making culture.



Flat Structure Diagram

Strengths:

- Faster Decisions – Fewer approval layers speed up responses
- Lower Costs – Reduced management positions decrease overhead
- Improved Communication – Direct access eliminates information filtering (related to functions of communication)
- Employee Empowerment – Greater autonomy increases motivation
- Innovation Culture – Open communication fosters creativity
- Flexibility – Quick adaptation to market changes
- Transparency – Fewer barriers create open organizational culture

Weaknesses:

- Role Confusion – Ambiguous responsibilities without clear hierarchy
- Limited Career Growth – Fewer promotion opportunities
- Manager Overload – Wide spans of control overwhelm supervisors

- Scalability Issues – Structure becomes chaotic as company grows
- Lack of Specialization – Employees may lack clear functional development
- Potential Chaos – Decision-making can become disorganized
- Not Universal – Some employees prefer clear direction and structure

Best For: Startups and creative teams that thrive on quick decisions, open communication, and minimal layers of management.

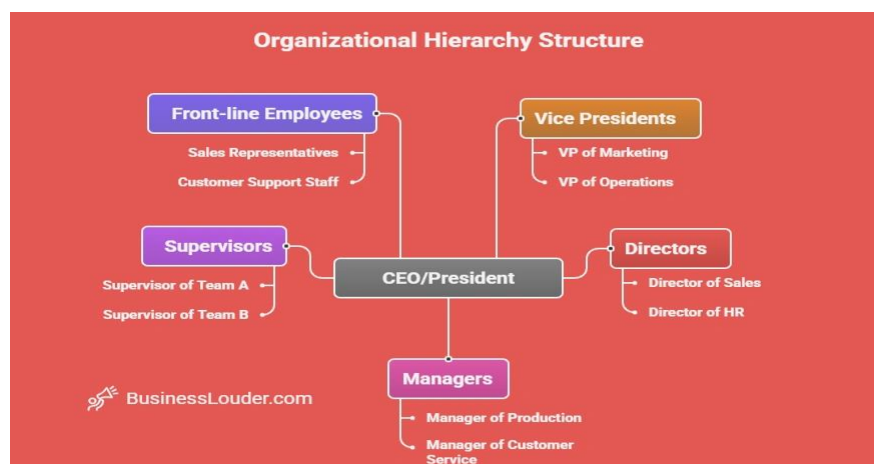
5. Hierarchical (Tall) Organizational Structure

The hierarchical structure features multiple management layers with clearly defined roles, strict reporting relationships, and formalized rules. This traditional “tall” structure emphasizes control, standardization, and clear authority.

Real-World Examples:

Government Organizations include federal agencies with multiple bureaucratic layers, military organizations with strict rank hierarchies, and public universities with defined administrative levels. Large Traditional Corporations: General Motors (automotive manufacturing), ExxonMobil (oil and gas operations), and JPMorgan Chase (banking and financial services).

Healthcare Systems: Large hospital networks, pharmaceutical companies (regulatory compliance focus).



Hierarchical (Tall) Organizational Structure

Strengths:

- Clear Authority – Everyone knows reporting relationships and responsibilities
- Defined Career Paths – Multiple levels provide advancement opportunities
- Specialization – Deep expertise development within narrow roles
- Control and Consistency – Standardized procedures ensure quality
- Large-Scale Management – Effectively manages thousands of employees
- Risk Management – Multiple approval layers prevent costly mistakes
- Stability – Formal structure provides organizational continuity

Weaknesses:

- Slow decision-making due to many layers
- High costs from multiple management levels
- Rigid structure that's slow to adapt
- Communication barriers and office politics
- Risk of low morale and limited innovation

This structure relates to understanding causes of conflict in organizations and requires strong workers participation in management.

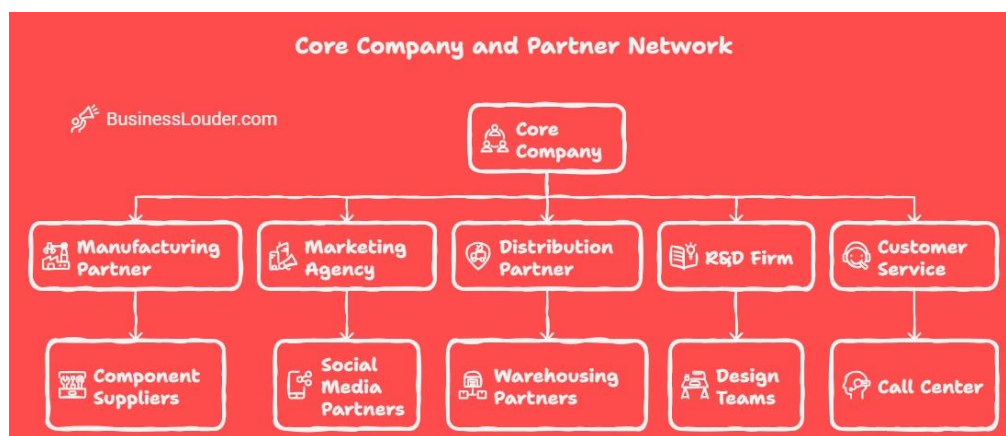
Best For: Big, structured, or heavily regulated organizations that depend on clear authority and well-defined reporting lines.

6. Network (Virtual) Organizational Structure:

The network structure outsources major business functions to external partners while maintaining a small core team for strategy and coordination. This creates a web of contractual relationships rather than a traditional hierarchy.

Real-World Examples:

- Nike operates with a core focused on Brand management, design, and marketing (76,000 employees) and outsources Manufacturing and distribution (1+ million contract workers), allowing the company to focus on brand while partners handle production.
- Apple (partially) maintains core functions in Product design, software development, and retail experience while outsourcing Manufacturing (Foxconn), component production, and assembly.
- Alibaba doesn't own inventory or warehouses but instead operates as a platform connecting buyers and sellers, coordinating a vast network of merchants and logistics providers.
- Uber/Airbnb operate with minimal physical assets owned and use a platform business model connecting supply and demand through a network of independent drivers/hosts.



Network Structure Diagram

Strengths:

- Flexibility – Quickly reconfigure partnerships based on needs
- Access to Expertise – Tap into specialized capabilities globally
- Lower Fixed Costs – Minimal infrastructure reduces overhead
- Core Competency Focus – Concentrate resources on strategic strengths
- Scalability – Easy expansion without hiring permanent staff
- Innovation Access – Leverage cutting-edge partner capabilities
- Global Reach – Operate internationally without physical presence
- Risk Sharing – Partners share operational and market risks

Weaknesses:

- Loss of Control – Less direct oversight of outsourced functions
- Dependency Risk – Partner failures directly impact your business

- Coordination Complexity – Managing multiple partners is challenging
- Quality Concerns – Maintaining consistent standards across network
- Intellectual Property Risk – Increased exposure to IP theft
- Cultural Differences – Partners may have conflicting values
- Communication Difficulties – Time zones and distance complicate coordination
- Reduced Loyalty – Contractors lack commitment to company mission

Best For: Modern, lean companies that outsource major functions and want a flexible setup that can scale without heavy internal staffing.

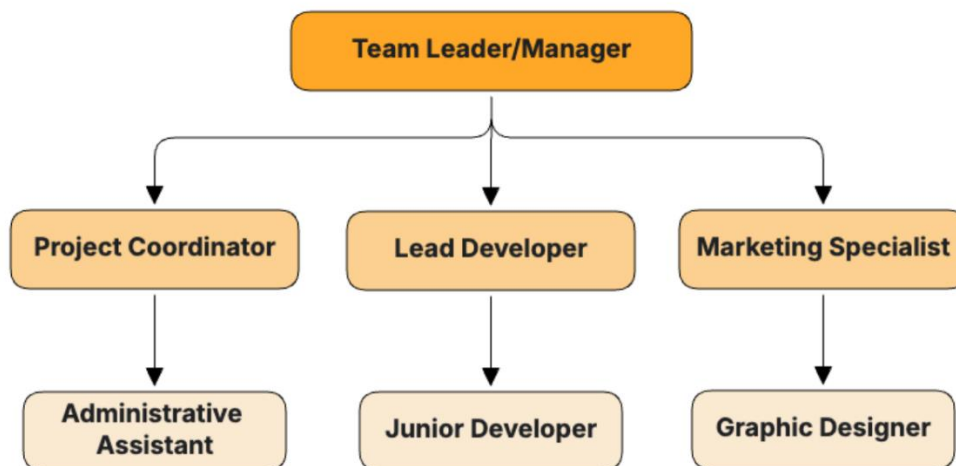
7. Team-Based (Circular) Organizational Structure

The team-based structure organizes around self-managed, cross-functional teams with decision-making authority and responsibility for complete work processes. Traditional departmental boundaries are eliminated in favor of collaborative pods or squads.

Real-World Examples:

- Spotify organizes into small squads (6-12 people per squad) as cross-functional teams with full autonomy, grouped into tribes and connected via guilds, with decentralized decision-making.
- Whole Foods Market uses self-managed teams by department in each store where teams make hiring, purchasing, and operational decisions with performance-based team compensation and a democratic team culture with voting rights.
- W.L. Gore & Associates (Gore-Tex) employs a lattice structure with small teams, no traditional management hierarchy, leaders who emerge based on follower support, and a team-driven innovation culture.

Team Structure Chart Template



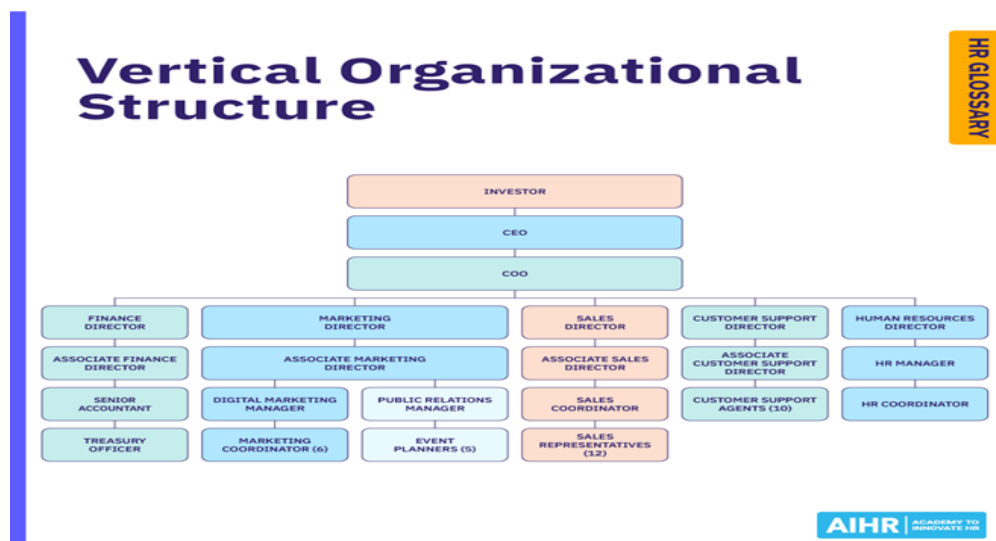
8 Vertical Organizational Structure:

vertical organizational structure and hierarchical organizational structure are closely related and often used interchangeably, but they are not exactly the same. There is a slight difference in meaning. A **vertical organizational structure** is a traditional form of organization in which authority, responsibility, and communication flow **from the top level of management down to the lower levels**. It is characterized by multiple layers of management and a clear chain of command. A vertical organizational structure is an arrangement where decision-making power is concentrated at the top levels, and instructions move downward through successive managerial levels.

In this structure, employees report to supervisors, supervisors report to managers, and managers report to top executives. Each level has defined roles and responsibilities.

Features of Vertical Organizational Structure

- 1. Clear Chain of Command**
 - Every employee knows whom to report to.
 - Authority flows from top management to lower levels.
- 2. Multiple Levels of Management**
 - Includes top management, middle management, and lower-level management.
 - Creates a tall organizational hierarchy.
- 3. Centralized Decision-Making**
 - Important decisions are taken by top management.
 - Lower levels implement decisions.
- 4. Defined Roles and Responsibilities**
 - Each employee has a specific job role.
 - Duties are clearly assigned.
- 5. Formal Communication**
 - Communication usually follows official channels.
 - Information moves step by step through levels.
- 6. Supervision and Control**
 - Managers closely supervise employees.
 - Helps maintain discipline and control.



Advantages

- 1. Clear Authority**
 - Everyone knows who is in charge.
- 2. Better Control**
 - Managers can easily supervise employees.
- 3. Defined Responsibilities**
 - Reduces confusion about roles.
- 4. Discipline**
 - Maintains order in the organization.

5. Accountability

- Easy to identify responsibility for tasks.

Disadvantages

1. Slow Decision-Making

- Decisions must pass through many levels.

2. Poor Communication

- Information may get distorted as it moves down.

3. Less Flexibility

- Difficult to adapt to changes quickly.

4. Employee Dissatisfaction

- Lower-level employees have less participation.

5. Higher Costs

- More managers mean higher administrative costs.

Suitable Organizations

Vertical organizational structure is suitable for:

- Large organizations
- Government institutions
- Manufacturing companies
- Traditional businesses
- Educational institutions

FORMATION OF GROUPS IN ORGANIZATIONS

Meaning of Group Formation

Group formation refers to the **process through which individuals come together and develop into functioning units** to achieve common goals. Groups may be formed formally by management or may emerge informally through social interactions. Robbins defines a group as two or more individuals who interact and are interdependent, working together to achieve particular objectives.

Reasons for Group Formation

Groups are formed in organizations for several reasons:

- **Task accomplishment:** Many organizational tasks require collective effort.
- **Security:** Groups provide a sense of protection and stability.
- **Affiliation:** Individuals have a natural need for social interaction.
- **Status and recognition:** Group membership provides identity and prestige.
- **Power:** Groups provide greater influence than individuals.
- **Goal achievement:** Complex goals are easier to achieve through teamwork.

Udai Pareek emphasizes that group formation satisfies both organizational needs and individual psychological needs.

Stages of Group Formation

Bruce Tuckman's model, widely discussed in Robbins and Luthans, explains how groups develop through five stages:

1. Forming

In this stage, members come together and get to know each other. Roles and objectives are unclear, and members depend on leadership for guidance.

2. Storming

Conflicts and disagreements arise as members compete for roles and influence. Power struggles are common in this stage.

3. Norming

Members begin to develop norms, trust, and cooperation. Relationships become stronger and group cohesion increases.

4. Performing

The group becomes mature and effective. Members work collaboratively to achieve goals.

5. Adjourning

Temporary groups disband after completing their tasks.

GROUPS IN ORGANIZATION

Meaning of Organizational Groups

Groups in organizations are **collections of individuals who interact to accomplish work-related goals**. They are the basic units through which organizational activities are carried out. Most modern organizations rely heavily on groups and teams for decision making, problem solving, and innovation.

Types of Groups in Organizations

Groups in organizations can be broadly classified into **formal groups** and **informal groups**.

1. Formal Groups

Formal groups are deliberately created by the organization to achieve specific objectives. They are defined by organizational structure, rules, and authority relationships.

Types of Formal Groups

- **Command** **Groups:**
These consist of a manager and his or her subordinates, as defined by the organizational chart.
- **Task** **Groups:**
Groups formed to complete a specific task or project. They may cut across departmental boundaries.
- **Committees** **and** **Project** **Teams:**
Temporary or permanent groups created to handle specialized assignments.

Formal groups are essential for coordination, control, and systematic achievement of organizational goals.

2. Informal Groups

Informal groups emerge naturally from social relationships among employees. They are not officially created but develop due to friendship, shared interests, or common problems.

Types of Informal Groups

- **Friendship Groups:** based on personal liking and social bonds.
- **Interest Groups:** formed to pursue common concerns such as welfare or workplace issues.

Informal groups satisfy social and emotional needs and strongly influence attitudes, communication, and behaviour at work.

Functions of Groups in Organizations

Groups perform several important functions:

- **Task Functions:** completing work, solving problems, and making decisions.
- **Social Functions:** providing belongingness, support, and identity.

- **Motivational Functions:** encouraging performance through peer influence.
- **Communication Functions:** facilitating information sharing.
- **Coordination Functions:** integrating efforts across departments.

Luthans highlights that effective groups create synergy where collective output exceeds individual contributions.

INFLUENCE OF GROUPS IN ORGANIZATION

Meaning of Group Influence

Group influence refers to the **impact that groups have on the attitudes, behaviour, performance, and decision-making of individual members and on the organization as a whole**. In organizational settings, employees rarely act in isolation; they work as part of teams, departments, committees, and informal social networks. According to Stephen P. Robbins, groups create norms, expectations, and pressures that shape how individuals think, feel, and behave at work. Therefore, understanding group influence is essential for managing people effectively.

Fred Luthans explains that groups exert both formal and informal influence on members. Formal influence arises from organizational rules and structures, while informal influence comes from peer relationships, social norms, and group culture. The behaviour of an individual employee is often more strongly affected by group expectations than by formal organizational policies.

Nature of Group Influence

Group influence is psychological as well as social in nature. When individuals join a group, they begin to identify with it and adjust their behaviour to fit group standards. Groups develop shared values, norms, and beliefs that guide members' actions. Over time, these influences become powerful determinants of performance, motivation, communication, and attitudes.

Udai Pareek points out that groups provide identity and emotional support to members, and this creates strong loyalty and conformity. As a result, group influence can be both positive and negative depending on how well the group's goals are aligned with organizational objectives.

AREAS IN WHICH GROUPS INFLUENCE ORGANIZATIONS

Groups influence organizations in several important ways:

1. Influence on Individual Behaviour

One of the strongest effects of groups is on the behaviour of individual members. People tend to modify their actions to match the expectations of the group. This occurs through group norms, peer pressure, and the desire for acceptance. Employees often behave differently in groups than when they are alone. For example, a normally quiet employee may become more confident and active in a supportive group environment.

Robbins emphasizes that groups shape work habits, discipline, punctuality, and attitudes toward authority. When group norms support hard work and responsibility, individual performance improves. When group norms encourage laziness or resistance, productivity suffers.

2. Influence on Attitudes and Values

Groups strongly influence the **attitudes, opinions, and values** of members. Through daily interaction, employees adopt the beliefs and viewpoints of their coworkers. Informal groups

in particular play a major role in shaping attitudes toward management, organizational policies, and change initiatives.

Luthans explains that group discussions and shared experiences gradually mold individual perceptions and feelings. If the dominant group attitude is positive, members are likely to develop commitment and loyalty. If the group attitude is negative, dissatisfaction and cynicism may spread throughout the organization.

3. Influence on Performance and Productivity

Group influence has a direct impact on employee performance. Cohesive and well-organized groups often achieve **higher productivity** because members support and motivate one another. Cooperation, coordination, and knowledge sharing within groups improve efficiency and quality of work.

However, group influence can also reduce performance. Phenomena such as **social loafing** (reduced individual effort in group tasks) and groupthink (poor decision making due to conformity) can negatively affect outcomes. Schermerhorn highlights that effective leadership and clear goals are necessary to ensure that group influence enhances rather than hinders productivity.

4. Influence on Motivation

Groups play an important role in motivating employees. Recognition from peers, acceptance within the group, and opportunities to contribute to team success are powerful motivators. Employees often work harder to avoid letting their group down.

Group-based reward systems, team incentives, and collective goals further strengthen motivation. Uday Pareek notes that group belongingness fulfills important psychological needs, which in turn increases enthusiasm and commitment to organizational objectives.

5. Influence on Communication

Groups greatly influence the **flow of communication** in organizations. Formal groups provide structured channels for sharing information related to tasks and responsibilities. Informal groups create unofficial communication networks, often called the “grapevine.”

While the grapevine can sometimes spread rumors, it also helps transmit information quickly and builds social bonds. Effective managers recognize the power of group communication and use it to support organizational goals.

6. Influence on Decision Making

Many organizational decisions are made through groups such as committees, project teams, and task forces. Group decision making allows pooling of knowledge, skills, and perspectives, often resulting in better-quality decisions than those made by individuals alone.

However, group influence can also create problems such as conformity pressure, domination by a few members, and groupthink. Robbins warns that managers must balance participation with independent thinking to ensure rational decisions.

7. Influence on Organizational Culture

Groups are the building blocks of organizational culture. The shared norms, rituals, and practices developed within groups gradually shape the overall climate of the organization. Strong groups help transmit cultural values to new employees and maintain stability.

If influential groups promote ethical behaviour and cooperation, a positive culture develops. If powerful informal groups resist management or encourage negative behaviour, organizational culture may deteriorate.

8. Influence on Change and Innovation

Groups play a crucial role in organizational change. Supportive groups can act as agents of change by encouraging members to adopt new technologies and methods. On the other hand, cohesive groups may resist change if they feel threatened.

Creativity and innovation are also strongly influenced by group interaction. Diverse and open-minded groups generate more ideas and solutions than isolated individuals.

GROUP DECISION MAKING AND ITS TECHNIQUES

Meaning of Group Decision Making

Group decision making refers to a process in which **two or more individuals collectively analyze problems, evaluate alternatives, and select a course of action**. In organizations, many important decisions are not taken by a single manager but by committees, task forces, project teams, or work groups. According to Stephen P. Robbins, group decision making is preferred in modern organizations because it allows pooling of knowledge, experience, and skills of many individuals, leading to more informed and balanced decisions.

Fred Luthans explains that group decision making is a participative process where members share ideas, debate alternatives, and arrive at a consensus or majority decision. This approach increases acceptance of decisions and improves commitment to implementation.

TECHNIQUES OF GROUP DECISION MAKING

Organizations use several structured techniques to improve the effectiveness of group decision making. The most important techniques are explained below.

1. Brainstorming

Brainstorming is a creative technique used to generate a large number of ideas in a short time.

Process:

- A group of 6–10 members is formed
- A problem is clearly defined
- Members are encouraged to suggest as many ideas as possible
- Criticism of ideas is not allowed
- Quantity of ideas is emphasized over quality
- Ideas are later evaluated and the best ones selected

Advantages:

- Encourages creativity
- Generates many alternatives
- Free and open participation

Limitations:

- Ideas may be unrealistic
- Dominant members may influence others
- No systematic evaluation during idea generation

2. Nominal Group Technique (NGT)

The Nominal Group Technique is a more structured method of group decision making.

Steps:

1. Members silently write down their ideas independently
2. Each member presents one idea in turn
3. Ideas are recorded without discussion
4. Group discusses each idea for clarification
5. Members privately rank or vote on ideas
6. The highest-ranked idea is selected

Advantages:

- Equal participation
- Reduces dominance by individuals
- Encourages independent thinking

Limitations:

- Less spontaneous interaction
- Time-consuming

3. Delphi Technique

The Delphi technique is used when group members are **geographically separated** and cannot meet face-to-face.

Process:

- A questionnaire is sent to experts
- Responses are collected and summarized
- The summary is sent back for further opinions
- Several rounds are conducted
- Finally, consensus is reached

Advantages:

- Useful for complex and strategic decisions
- Avoids face-to-face conflicts
- Allows participation of experts from different locations

Limitations:

- Slow process
- Lack of direct interaction

4. Electronic Meeting

This is a modern technique where group decision making is done through computers and digital technology.

Features:

- Members sit at computers in a networked room
- Ideas are typed anonymously
- Voting and ranking are done electronically
- Results are instantly displayed

Advantages:

- Fast and efficient
- Anonymity reduces pressure
- Accurate recording of ideas

Limitations:

- Requires technical infrastructure
- Less personal interaction

5. Consensus Mapping

Consensus mapping helps groups arrive at a common agreement by organizing ideas into logical categories and identifying relationships among them.

Advantages:

- Reduces conflicts
- Builds shared understanding
- Useful for complex problems

6. Fishbowl Technique

In this method, a small group discusses the problem while others observe. Later, observers provide feedback and suggestions.

7. Devil's Advocacy

One member is assigned the role of a critic to challenge assumptions and point out weaknesses in proposed alternatives. This reduces the risk of groupthink.

COMMUNICATION

Meaning and Definition of Communication

Communication is the process through which **information, ideas, thoughts, opinions, and emotions are exchanged between individuals or groups**. In simple terms, communication means the transfer of meaning from one person to another. According to Stephen P. Robbins, communication is "the transfer and understanding of meaning." Fred Luthans defines communication as a process of transmitting information and common understanding from one person to another.

In organizational behavior, communication is not merely sending messages; it also includes **ensuring that the receiver understands the message in the way the sender intended**. Therefore, effective communication is essential for coordination, cooperation, and smooth functioning of any organization.

NATURE OF COMMUNICATION

Communication in organizations has the following important characteristics:

- It is a continuous and dynamic process
- It involves at least two parties – sender and receiver
- It is a two-way process
- It involves sharing of ideas and understanding
- It can be formal or informal
- It may be verbal or non-verbal
- The effectiveness depends on feedback

Communication is therefore both a psychological and social process that links people, tasks, and organizational goals.

IMPORTANCE OF COMMUNICATION

Communication is considered the **lifeblood of an organization**. Without communication, no organization can function effectively. Its importance can be explained as follows:

1. Basis of Planning and Decision Making

All managerial functions such as planning, organizing, directing, and controlling depend on accurate and timely communication. Managers need information to make effective decisions.

2. Coordination

Communication helps in coordinating the activities of different departments and individuals. It integrates various organizational functions.

3. Motivation of Employees

Through communication, managers can encourage, guide, and inspire employees. Goals, expectations, and rewards are communicated to improve motivation.

4. Building Relationships

Effective communication promotes trust, understanding, and good interpersonal relationships among employees.

5. Smooth Functioning

Instructions, policies, procedures, and feedback are transmitted through communication, ensuring smooth organizational operations.

6. Conflict Resolution

Open communication helps in identifying and resolving misunderstandings and conflicts.

COMMUNICATION PROCESS

Communication is a systematic process involving several elements.

Step	1:	Sender
The One Who Begins the Communication		

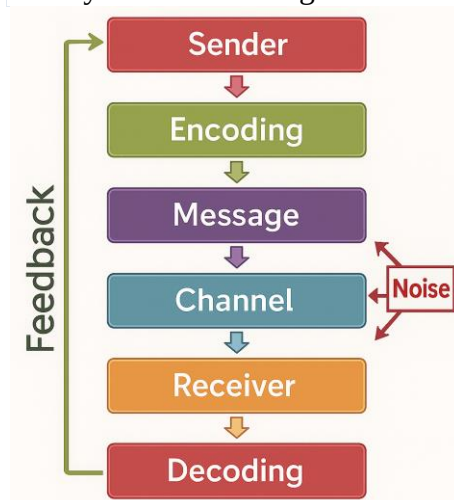
The first step in the **7-step communication process** is the **sender**. This is the person who starts the communication by having an idea, thought, or feeling they want to share. The entire process begins with the sender, making this step extremely important.

The sender must be clear about what they want to say and why they want to say it. Their choice of words, tone, and timing all influence how the message will be received and understood.

Step	2:	Encoding
Turning Ideas into Words, Symbols, or Actions		

The second step in the **7 steps of the communication process** is **encoding**. This is when the sender takes the idea in their mind and turns it into a message that can be shared. Encoding involves choosing the right words, gestures, tone, or visuals to help the receiver understand the message clearly.

This step is about making thoughts understandable. The sender has to think carefully about how to express the idea in a way that suits the listener. It is especially important for children, as they are still learning how to match thoughts with clear expressions.



Step 3: Message

The Actual Content Being Shared

The third step in the 7 steps of the communication process is the message. This is the actual content that the sender wants to deliver to the receiver. It could be spoken words, written text, a picture, a gesture, or a combination of all of these. The message carries the idea that was formed and encoded in the earlier steps.

This step might seem simple, but it is at the heart of the entire communication process. If the message is unclear or poorly delivered, it can lead to confusion, misunderstandings, or even conflict.

Step 4: Channel

The Path the Message Takes

The fourth step in the 7 steps of communication process is the channel. This refers to the method or medium through which the message travels from the sender to the receiver. It is the path that connects both people and carries the message between them.

The channel can be anything that allows communication to happen. It could be a face-to-face conversation, a phone call, a video, a written note, or even a hand gesture. Choosing the right channel is important because it affects how well the message is received.

Step 5: Receiver

The Person Who Gets the Message

The fifth step in the 7 steps of communication process is the receiver. This is the person for whom the message is intended. The receiver listens, reads, or observes the message and then tries to understand what the sender wants to say.

The success of communication depends not only on how well the message is sent, but also on how well it is received. The receiver needs to be focused and willing to understand the message in order for communication to be complete.

Step 6: Decoding

Understanding the Message

The sixth step in the 7 steps of communication process is decoding. This is the stage where the receiver takes the message they have received and tries to understand what it means. Just as the sender encodes the message, the receiver must decode it to make sense of the information being shared.

Decoding is not always easy. It depends on how clearly the message was sent, as well as the receiver's ability to understand the language, tone, or non-verbal cues.

Step 7: Feedback

The Response to the Message

The seventh and final step in the 7 steps of communication process is feedback. This is the response the receiver gives after decoding and understanding the message. Feedback helps the sender know whether the message was received correctly and understood as intended.

Feedback can be spoken or written, but it can also be shown through actions, expressions, or gestures. It closes the communication loop and allows for clarification, encouragement, or further discussion.

Types of Organizational Communication

Organizational communication can be divided into several types according to the direction of communication messages, formality levels like channels used and information exchanged. Here are some common types of organizational communication:

1. Formal Communication: Formal Communication also known as official communication is the communication in which information reaches through formal routes. The primary objective of this communication is to communicate correctly and ensure that the information is conveyed correctly. This form of communication is considered an efficient mode as it's time-saving and has organised its flow.

2. Informal Communication: Communication that doesn't use formal means to communicate is referred to as informal communication. Individuals, and/or subordinates do not adhere to the strict policies of the company. People talk to each other without any restrictions. Informal communication at the organizational level is considered to be spontaneous, where subordinates and their superiors can freely talk in the absence of official rules, systems or instructions to communicate. One of the most common forms of informal communication is talking to your friends or family.

3. Lateral or Horizontal Communication: Communication that takes place between individuals or groups on the same rung of the hierarchy. It makes it easier to coordinate, find solutions and share information between colleagues working in different departments or teams.

4. External Communication: Customer Communication: Customers must interact through various channels, including customer support, marketing materials and product informing of items or services.

5. Supplier Communication: Contacting suppliers about orders, deliveries and other business topics.

6. Public Relations: Interfacing with the public, media and other external stakeholders to control how the organization is perceived by them.

7. Official Documents and Reports: Forms of formal written communication include the following documents policies procedures reports manuals. These documents are a structured and standardized means of communicating information within the organization.

8. Face-to-Face Communication: Coordinated efforts meetings, conferences, and personally arranged individual contacts where information is specifically discussed via spoken words or nonverbal signs, important discussions, decision-making, and relationship building often occur in face-to-face communication.

9. Electronic Communication:

Emails: Formal electronic communication where information is shared, matters discussed and tasks coordinated.

Instant Messaging: Informal communication through real-time text messages (used for quick exchanges and team collaboration).

Video Conferencing: Virtual face-to-face communication where individuals can communicate in real-time without barriers of distance.

10. Feedback and Performance Reviews: Formalized means of providing feedback on employee performance such as scheduled reviews, appraisals and constructive criticism.

11. Symbols and Visual Communication: This includes the utilization of symbols and logos. Visuals demonstrate complicated data and ideas effectively.

Benefits of Good Organizational Communication

1. **Increased Productivity:** Clear and effective communication ensures that tasks are understood, expectations are communicated, and information flows smoothly. This leads to enhanced productivity as employees can perform their roles efficiently without unnecessary delays or misunderstandings.

2. **Improved Employee Morale:** When workers feel knowledgeable, listened to and respected it fosters higher morale. Good interpersonal communication results in a healthy work atmosphere, promoting an environment of belonging and job satisfaction.

3. **Enhanced Employee Engagement:** Good communication keeps the employees engaged because it gives them a concrete understanding of what those goals, strategies and their own roles are within that framework.

4. **Reduced Conflicts:** Open and honest communication ensures that conflicts are prevented as well as solved. If expectations are communicated clearly, and misunderstanding is addressed promptly conflicts between individuals decrease.

5. **Increased Innovation and Creativity:** Open culture of communication facilitates ideas exchange and feedback. This, in turn, encourages innovation and creativity since employees find themselves empowered to offer their thoughts as well as suggestions free of fear of retaliation.

6. **Better Decision-Making:** Good communication ensures that decision-makers are available with pertinent information. Sharing raw data and insights is essential to informed decision-making in an organization because effective communication channels enable the employees to get all necessary information, at least once.

7. **Stronger Teamwork and Collaboration:** Effective communication fosters a positive teamwork and collaboration atmosphere. More efficiently, teams can work together to share information seamlessly and contribute by pooling resources towards the achievement of common goals.

8. **Adaptability to Change:** In times of change in an organization, communication must be clear. It points employees out on the reasons for the change, the outcomes they are to expect and their role in it. This, in turn, facilitates a smoother transition and improved adaptability to change.

9. **Customer Satisfaction:** It is also equally important to communicate with customers and clients externally. It ensures that customers are adequately informed, their concerns addressed, and feedback is taken seriously. This results in increased customer satisfaction and loyalty levels.

10. **Improved Leadership Effectiveness:** Leaders who communicate effectively inspire confidence and trust. Their ability to articulate a vision, provide clear guidance, and engage with employees contributes to effective leadership and organizational success.

Challenges of Organizational Communication

On the one hand, effective organizational communication cannot be overemphasized as being very beneficial; however, it is not without its problems. Identifying and engaging these challenges is vital for preserving a healthy communication atmosphere. Some common challenges include:

1. **Barriers to Communication:** Different obstacles impede efficient communication such as the lack of a common language, cultural diversity and perceptual differences. Due to these barriers, messages may be misinterpreted and cause misunderstanding or confusion.

2. **Information Overload:** Today's workplaces are busy, and employees receive a steady stream of information. It can result in difficulties processing important messages, and key information may be overlooked or ignored.

3. Lack of Clarity in Communication: Ambiguous or vague communication can cause misunderstanding and misinterpretations. Poor communication as regards expectations, goals or procedures related to an organization's activity can negatively affect organizational performance.

4. Poorly Managed Feedback: Poor feedback mechanisms or lack of constructive criticism can limit the effectiveness of communication. Feedback is also a crucial aspect. In the absence of it, employees do not fully know how well they are performing or what their contributions mean for organizational purposes.

5. Resistance to Change: It is hard to communicate organizational changes, especially where employees are resistant. The lack of an effective communication strategy to convey reasons for change and the benefits it will provide can also increase scepticism and resistance.

6. Diverse Communication Styles: Communication styles vary from one person to another, and their understanding and adjustment can be quite difficult. Different styles of communication preferences may result in misunderstandings and collaborative difficulties.

7. Geographical and Cultural Differences: Geographical and cultural diversities make communication within globally dispersed organizations challenging. Communication and cooperation may become complicated by time zone diversities, language differences, and cultural intricacies.

8. Technology Issues: Technology may be facilitating communication, but it also poses challenges. Organizations may encounter issues such as technical glitches, relying on impersonal communication tools and the possibility of miscommunications in virtual command.

9. Ineffective Leadership Communication: Leaders have to communicate well in order to inspire confidence and offer direction. Productive and positive leadership communication, including transparency, may result in uncertainty or inconsistency of the messaging, affecting employee trust.

10. Overemphasis on Written Communication: Managing with just written communication, like emails and documents may result in misinterpretations. Non-verbal cues and tone are equally important parts of communication that have the possibility to be missing in written formats.

11. Poorly Managed Grapevine Communication: The misinformation and the rumours are instead, spread through informal communication channels, like office gossip or grapevine. If these channels are not managed properly, they can lead to a negative organizational culture and lower morale.

12. Time Constraints: Busy schedules and limited time can significantly reduce the opportunities for effective communication.

ORGANIZATIONAL CONTROL

INTRODUCTION

In organizational behaviour and management, planning alone cannot ensure success. Plans must be monitored, evaluated, and regulated to ensure that organizational goals are actually achieved. This regulating mechanism is known as **organizational control**. Control is one of the most important managerial functions because it connects planning with actual performance.

According to **Stephen P. Robbins**, organizational control is a process of monitoring activities to ensure that they are being accomplished as planned and correcting any significant deviations. **Fred Luthans** explains control as the mechanism through which managers ensure that individual and group behavior is consistent with organizational objectives. Therefore, organizational control is not only a mechanical process but also a behavioral process that influences how people act within organizations.

DEFINITION OF ORGANIZATIONAL CONTROL

Different organizational behaviour scholars define control in the following ways:

- Robbins defines control as “the process of monitoring performance, comparing it with goals, and correcting any significant deviations.”
- Luthans views organizational control as a system that guides employee behavior and aligns it with organizational goals.
- Schermerhorn, Hunt and Osborn describe control as a managerial process of measuring performance and taking action to ensure desired results.

From these definitions, organizational control can be understood as:

A systematic process of regulating organizational activities and employee behavior in order to ensure that actual performance matches planned objectives.

NATURE OF ORGANIZATIONAL CONTROL

The nature of organizational control can be clearly understood through the following characteristics, which are emphasized in Robbins and Luthans:

1. Control is Goal-Oriented

Control always focuses on achieving organizational goals. Without clearly defined goals, control cannot exist.

2. Control is Continuous

Control is not a one-time activity. It is an ongoing process that operates throughout the life of the organization.

3. Control is Linked with Planning

Planning and control are closely related. Planning sets goals and standards, while control ensures that those goals are achieved.

4. Control is Future-Oriented

Although control measures past performance, its purpose is to improve future performance.

5. Control Involves Measurement and Comparison

Control requires objective standards against which actual performance can be measured and evaluated.

6. Control is Both Behavioral and Technical

Control deals not only with machines, finance, and systems but also with human behavior, attitudes, and performance.

IMPORTANCE OF ORGANIZATIONAL CONTROL

All the prescribed textbooks emphasize that control is essential for organizational success. Its importance can be elaborated as follows:

1. Ensures Achievement of Objectives

Organizational control ensures that all activities are moving in the direction of planned objectives. It prevents deviation from goals and keeps the organization focused.

2. Improves Efficiency and Effectiveness

Through continuous monitoring, control helps in better utilization of resources such as time, money, materials, and human effort. This improves overall efficiency.

3. Helps in Coordination

Control integrates the activities of different individuals and departments. It ensures that all units of the organization work together harmoniously.

4. Facilitates Decision Making

Control systems provide managers with accurate information about actual performance. This information helps managers make timely and rational decisions.

5. Motivates Employees

When employees know that their performance is being measured against clear standards, they are motivated to work more sincerely and efficiently.

6. Reduces Errors and Deviations

By identifying mistakes and deviations early, control helps organizations take corrective action before problems become serious.

7. Helps in Adapting to Change

In a dynamic business environment, control systems help organizations adjust to new situations and external changes.

THE ORGANIZATIONAL CONTROL PROCESS

According to Robbins and Schermerhorn, control follows a systematic and logical process consisting of several steps.

Step 1: Establishing Standards

The first step in the control process is to set clear and measurable standards of performance. Standards are the benchmarks against which actual performance will be compared.

Standards may relate to:

- Quantity of output
- Quality of work
- Time schedules
- Costs and budgets
- Employee behavior

These standards must be:

- Realistic
- Specific
- Measurable
- Achievable
- Clearly communicated to employees

Step 2: Measuring Actual Performance

Once standards are established, the next step is to measure actual performance. Performance can be measured through:

- Observation
- Reports
- Statistical data
- Performance appraisals
- Audits and inspections

Accurate and reliable measurement is essential for effective control.

Step 3: Comparing Actual Performance with Standards

In this stage, managers compare what has actually happened with what was planned. This comparison helps to identify:

- Whether performance meets expectations
- The extent of deviation
- Areas that need improvement

Step 4: Analyzing Deviations

If there is a gap between actual performance and standards, managers must analyze the reasons for this gap. Deviations may occur due to:

- Poor planning
- Lack of resources
- Employee inefficiency
- External environmental factors

Understanding the real cause is necessary before taking corrective action.

Step 5: Taking Corrective Action

The final step in the control process is to take corrective action to remove deviations. Corrective actions may include:

- Training employees
- Revising plans and standards
- Improving supervision
- Changing methods or procedures

This step ensures continuous organizational improvement.

TYPES OF ORGANIZATIONAL CONTROL (As per Textbooks)

Robbins and Luthans classify organizational control into different types based on timing and focus.

1. Feedforward Control (Preliminary Control)

Feedforward control focuses on preventing problems before they occur. It is future-oriented.

Examples:

- Setting rules and procedures
- Proper recruitment and training
- Planning budgets in advance

This type of control aims to eliminate potential errors at the input stage itself.

2. Concurrent Control

Concurrent control takes place while activities are in progress. It involves real-time monitoring and supervision.

Examples:

- Direct supervision of workers
- Quality checks during production

- Monitoring ongoing projects

It allows immediate corrective action.

3. Feedback Control

Feedback control takes place after the activity is completed. It is based on past results.

Examples:

- Annual performance appraisal
- Financial audits
- Sales reports

Feedback control helps in improving future performance.

TEAM BUILDING IN ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOUR

In modern organizations, work is increasingly accomplished through teams rather than individuals working in isolation. Organizations face complex tasks that require coordination, collaboration, and shared responsibility. Therefore, team building has become a critical aspect of organizational behaviour. Team building is not merely forming a group of people; it is a deliberate and systematic process of developing a group into a cohesive, high-performing team.

According to Robbins, a team is a group whose individual efforts result in performance that is greater than the sum of individual inputs. Luthans emphasizes that team building is a structured process aimed at improving interpersonal relations and social interactions within work groups. Thus, team building focuses on enhancing trust, communication, cooperation, and collective performance.

MEANING OF TEAM BUILDING

Team building refers to a planned effort to improve a team's effectiveness through structured activities, problem-solving exercises, feedback sessions, and interpersonal skill development. It is often considered a part of organizational development (OD) interventions.

Udai Pareek explains that team building involves diagnosing group processes and improving them to increase effectiveness and satisfaction among members. It focuses on improving relationships, clarifying roles, resolving conflicts, and enhancing mutual trust.

OBJECTIVES OF TEAM BUILDING

The major objectives of team building include:

1. Improving communication among members
2. Increasing mutual trust and understanding
3. Clarifying roles and responsibilities
4. Enhancing collaboration and coordination
5. Resolving interpersonal conflicts
6. Improving problem-solving abilities
7. Strengthening commitment to team goals

Team building aims at both task effectiveness and relationship effectiveness.

THE IMPORTANCE OF TEAM BUILDING IN ORGANIZATIONS

Team building is a process that aims to enhance the effectiveness of a group by improving collaboration, communication, and problem-solving abilities. In any organizational setting, the team is often the primary engine that drives progress. Whether it's a small department or a large-scale project team, how well members of the group interact with one another determines how smoothly and effectively tasks are completed. Research consistently shows that well-structured teams can accomplish far more than individuals working independently. Effective team building enhances these collective strengths by aligning the team's goals with the organization's vision.

Teams that work well together often experience increased motivation, improved job satisfaction, and better overall productivity. A lack of teamwork, on the other hand, can lead to misunderstandings, conflicts, and inefficiency. The challenges and pressures of modern work environments, such as tight deadlines and shifting organizational goals, make teamwork even more important. The need for teams to work collaboratively, support each other, and function smoothly in high-pressure situations calls for deliberate efforts toward building stronger teams.

STAGES OF TEAM DEVELOPMENT

Robbins discusses group development stages based on Tuckman's model, which is closely related to team building.

1. Forming

Members come together and begin to understand the team's purpose. There is uncertainty about roles and leadership.

Characteristics:

- Polite behavior
- Dependence on leader
- Limited communication

2. Storming

Conflicts arise due to differences in opinions, personalities, and expectations.

Characteristics:

- Disagreements
- Power struggles
- Clarification of roles

Effective team building at this stage helps resolve conflicts.

3. Norming

Team members develop norms and mutual understanding.

Characteristics:

- Increased cooperation
- Trust development
- Shared expectations

4. Performing

The team functions effectively toward goal achievement.

Characteristics:

- High productivity
- Strong commitment

- Effective problem-solving



KEY STRATEGIES FOR SUCCESSFUL TEAM BUILDING

While activities play an essential role in team building, there are also several broader strategies that can lead to more successful outcomes:

- **Clear communication:** Open, honest, and clear communication is the foundation of any successful team. Ensuring that all team members understand each other's expectations and concerns is crucial for collaboration. Establishing regular check-ins and feedback loops helps prevent misunderstandings.
- **Shared goals:** A team must have a clear sense of direction. Each team member should understand how their individual contributions align with the larger goals of the organization. This shared understanding of purpose creates motivation and fosters a sense of unity.
- **Role clarity:** Every team member should have a clear understanding of their role within the team. When roles are well-defined, individuals can work more efficiently and avoid stepping on each other's toes.
- **Encouraging collaboration:** Promoting a collaborative mindset within the team ensures that all members contribute their unique skills and perspectives. Collaboration fosters creativity and innovation, leading to better solutions and improved team dynamics.
- **Conflict resolution:** Disagreements are natural in any team, but handling conflict in a constructive way is crucial. Encouraging open dialogue and providing tools for conflict resolution helps teams maintain a positive and productive atmosphere.

INTERPERSONAL RELATIONS IN ORGANIZATIONAL BEHAVIOUR

INTRODUCTION

Organizations are social systems where individuals interact continuously with one another. No employee works in isolation; rather, they depend on colleagues, supervisors, subordinates, and customers. The quality of these interactions significantly influences organizational

effectiveness. Interpersonal relations therefore form the foundation of organizational behaviour.

According to Robbins, interpersonal relations refer to the way individuals interact, communicate, and relate to one another within organizational settings. Luthans emphasizes that understanding interpersonal behavior is crucial for improving communication, cooperation, motivation, and performance. Thus, interpersonal relations are concerned with building positive, productive, and harmonious relationships among individuals at the workplace.

MEANING OF INTERPERSONAL RELATIONS

Interpersonal relations refer to the patterns of interaction, communication, and behavior between individuals in an organization. It includes how people:

- Communicate
- Resolve conflicts
- Express emotions
- Build trust
- Influence one another

Udai Pareek explains that interpersonal relations are shaped by perceptions, attitudes, values, personality traits, and emotional responses. Healthy interpersonal relationships contribute to a positive organizational climate and employee satisfaction.

IMPORTANCE OF INTERPERSONAL RELATIONS

Interpersonal relations play a vital role in organizational success. Their importance can be understood as follows:

1. Improves Communication

Effective interpersonal relationships enhance clarity, openness, and understanding in communication.

2. Enhances Teamwork

Strong relationships promote cooperation and collaboration among team members.

3. Increases Job Satisfaction

Employees who maintain positive relationships at work experience higher morale and satisfaction.

4. Reduces Conflict

Healthy interpersonal understanding helps prevent misunderstandings and conflicts.

5. Improves Organizational Climate

Positive relationships contribute to trust, mutual respect, and psychological safety.

6. Enhances Productivity

When employees work harmoniously, performance and efficiency improve.

FACTORS INFLUENCING INTERPERSONAL RELATIONS

According to OB scholars, several factors influence the quality of interpersonal relations:

1. Perception

Perception plays a major role in how individuals interpret others' behavior. Misinterpretation can lead to misunderstanding and conflict. Robbins emphasizes that selective perception, stereotyping, and attribution errors influence interpersonal relations.

2. Personality

Individual personality traits such as openness, agreeableness, emotional stability, and extroversion affect how people relate to others.

3. Attitudes and Values

Differences in beliefs, values, and attitudes may create harmony or conflict in relationships.

4. Communication Skills

Effective listening, clarity in expression, empathy, and feedback enhance relationships.

5. Emotional Intelligence

The ability to understand and manage one's own emotions and others' emotions strengthens interpersonal interactions.

6. Trust

Trust is the foundation of any strong relationship. Lack of trust leads to suspicion and poor cooperation.

KEY INTERPERSONAL SKILLS IN ORGANIZATIONS

Organizational behaviour literature identifies several core interpersonal skills necessary for effective functioning.

1. Effective Communication

Communication is the foundation of interpersonal skills. It includes:

- Clear verbal communication
- Appropriate non-verbal communication
- Active listening
- Constructive feedback

Robbins emphasizes that effective communication improves performance and reduces ambiguity in organizations.

2. Active Listening

Active listening involves giving full attention to the speaker, understanding the message, and responding appropriately. It includes:

- Maintaining eye contact
- Avoiding interruptions
- Asking clarifying questions
- Providing feedback

Listening enhances understanding and strengthens relationships.

3. Emotional Intelligence

Emotional intelligence (EI) refers to the ability to recognize, understand, and manage one's own emotions and the emotions of others. It includes:

- Self-awareness
- Self-regulation
- Motivation
- Empathy
- Social skills

Luthans highlights that emotionally intelligent managers handle stress and interpersonal conflicts more effectively.

4. Empathy

Empathy is the ability to understand another person's feelings and perspective. It promotes sensitivity, compassion, and supportive relationships.

5. Conflict Management Skills

Effective managers use different conflict-handling styles such as:

- Collaboration
- Compromise
- Accommodation
- Avoidance
- Competition

Proper conflict resolution strengthens team relationships rather than damaging them.

6. Assertiveness

Assertiveness means expressing one's thoughts and feelings confidently and respectfully without being aggressive. It balances self-respect and respect for others.

7. Feedback Skills

Giving and receiving constructive feedback is essential for performance improvement. Feedback should be:

- Specific
- Timely
- Objective
- Development-oriented

8. Trust-Building

Trust is built through:

- Honesty
- Consistency
- Integrity
- Reliability

Trust enhances collaboration and reduces workplace stress.

9. Negotiation Skills

Negotiation skills are necessary for resolving disagreements and reaching mutually beneficial solutions.

BARRIERS TO EFFECTIVE INTERPERSONAL SKILLS

Several factors may hinder interpersonal effectiveness:

1. Poor communication
2. Emotional instability
3. Stereotyping and biases
4. Lack of trust
5. Cultural differences
6. Ego clashes

Managers must recognize and overcome these barriers to maintain healthy relationships.

BENEFITS OF STRONG INTERPERSONAL SKILLS

1. Higher employee engagement
2. Reduced workplace conflicts

3. Improved teamwork
4. Better decision-making
5. Increased productivity
6. Positive organizational culture
7. Strong leadership effectiveness

Interpersonal skills are essential for effective functioning in organizations. They influence communication, leadership, teamwork, motivation, and conflict management. As emphasized in Robbins, Luthans, Schermerhorn, and Pareek, employees and managers who possess strong interpersonal skills contribute significantly to organizational success. In modern organizations, technical skills may secure a job, but interpersonal skills ensure career growth and leadership effectiveness.